

Chapter 3: Digital Awareness

Class 11 – Cyber Safety, Strong Passwords & Safe Internet Practices

Learning Objectives

After completing this lesson, students will be able to:

- Understand the meaning of cyber safety.
 - Learn safe internet browsing practices.
 - Create and use strong passwords.
 - Protect personal information online.
 - Identify safe and unsafe websites.
 - Recognize cyberbullying, phishing, and online scams.
 - Practice responsible internet usage and good digital citizenship.
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Introduction

The internet is a wonderful place for learning, communication, entertainment, and sharing information. However, it is important to stay safe while using the internet. **Cyber Safety** means protecting ourselves, our personal information, and our devices from online dangers.

By following simple safety rules, students can enjoy the internet safely and responsibly.

What is Cyber Safety?

Cyber Safety means using computers, mobile devices, and the internet safely while protecting ourselves from online threats.

Importance of Cyber Safety

- Protects personal information.
- Prevents online fraud.
- Keeps devices secure.
- Protects online accounts.
- Encourages responsible internet use.

Safe Internet Browsing

Safe browsing means visiting trusted websites and using the internet carefully.

Safe Browsing Tips

- Visit trusted and educational websites.
- Check the website address before opening it.
- Avoid clicking unknown links.
- Do not download files from unknown websites.
- Close suspicious pop-up windows.
- Ask a parent or teacher before visiting new websites.

Strong Password Creation

A **password** protects your online accounts and personal information.

Characteristics of a Strong Password

- At least **8 characters** long.
- Includes uppercase letters (A–Z).
- Includes lowercase letters (a–z).
- Includes numbers (0–9).
- Includes special symbols (!, @, #, \$, %, &).

Example

Strong Password: Learn@2026

Avoid Using

- Your name
 - Date of birth
 - Phone number
 - Simple passwords like **123456** or **password**
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Password Security

Keeping passwords safe is very important.

Password Safety Rules

- Never share your password with anyone except a trusted parent or guardian.
 - Change passwords regularly.
 - Use different passwords for different accounts.
 - Log out after using shared computers.
 - Do not write passwords where others can see them.
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Personal Information Protection

Personal information should always remain private.

Examples of Personal Information

- Full Name
- Home Address
- Phone Number
- School Name
- Email Address
- Passwords
- Photographs
- Bank Details

Safety Tips

- Never share personal information with strangers.
 - Think before posting photos online.
 - Ask an adult before filling out online forms.
 - Keep privacy settings enabled on online accounts.
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Safe Website Identification

Not all websites are safe.

How to Identify Safe Websites

- Look for **https://** at the beginning of the website address.
 - Check for the **padlock icon** in the browser.
 - Visit official and trusted websites.
 - Avoid websites with suspicious advertisements or warnings.
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Cyberbullying Awareness

Cyberbullying means using digital technology to hurt, threaten, or embarrass someone.

Examples

- Sending hurtful messages.
- Sharing embarrassing photos.
- Posting rude comments.
- Spreading false information.

What Should You Do?

- Do not respond to hurtful messages.
 - Save evidence if necessary.
 - Block the person.
 - Tell a trusted parent or teacher immediately.
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Phishing (Basic Introduction)

Phishing is a trick used by cybercriminals to steal personal information by pretending to be a trusted person or organization.

Examples

- Fake emails asking for passwords.
- Fake messages claiming you won a prize.
- Fake banking links.
- Fake login pages.

How to Stay Safe

- Never click suspicious links.
- Do not share passwords or OTPs.
- Verify messages before responding.

- Ask an adult if you are unsure.
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Online Scams (Introduction)

An **online scam** is an attempt to cheat people through the internet.

Examples

- Fake shopping websites.
- Prize-winning messages.
- Fake job offers.
- Fake social media accounts.

Safety Rules

- Do not trust offers that seem too good to be true.
 - Verify information before making decisions.
 - Report suspicious websites or messages.
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Safe Downloads

Download files only from trusted sources.

Guidelines

- Use official websites.
 - Scan downloaded files with antivirus software.
 - Avoid downloading unknown games or apps.
 - Ask a teacher or parent before installing software.
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Responsible Internet Usage

Students should always use the internet responsibly.

Good Internet Habits

- Use the internet for learning.

- Respect others online.
 - Follow school internet rules.
 - Avoid inappropriate websites.
 - Report unsafe content.
 - Think before posting anything online.
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Digital Footprint

A **digital footprint** is the record of everything we do online.

Examples

- Emails sent
- Photos uploaded
- Comments posted
- Websites visited
- Videos watched

Always remember that online activities may leave a lasting record.

Screen Time Management

Too much screen time can affect health.

Healthy Habits

- Take breaks every 20–30 minutes.
 - Balance screen time with outdoor activities.
 - Sit with proper posture.
 - Sleep well and avoid excessive device use before bedtime.
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Internet Safety Rules

- Never share passwords.
- Never share personal information.
- Visit trusted websites only.
- Use strong passwords.

- Log out after using shared devices.
 - Report suspicious messages.
 - Ask adults for help when unsure.
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Benefits of Cyber Safety

- Protects your identity.
 - Keeps personal information secure.
 - Prevents cybercrime.
 - Builds responsible digital habits.
 - Makes internet use safe and enjoyable.
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Did You Know?

- Cyber Safety helps protect millions of internet users every day.
 - Strong passwords are one of the best ways to protect online accounts.
 - Most secure websites use **HTTPS** and display a padlock icon.
 - Every action performed online contributes to your digital footprint.
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Points to Remember

- Cyber Safety helps protect people while using the internet.
- Always use strong and unique passwords.
- Keep personal information private.
- Visit only trusted websites.
- Never click unknown links or download unknown files.
- Report cyberbullying or suspicious online activities to a trusted adult.
- Practice good digital citizenship every day.